

4.4: Shear Flow in Thin-Walled Beams Due to Transverse Loads

- We will assume the beam is untapered (i.e. constant cross section) so that I_y , I_z , and I_{yz} do not vary in the x direction
- Therefore differentiating both sides of this formula with respect to x yields:

$$\frac{\partial \sigma_x}{\partial x} = \frac{-y \left[(I_y) \frac{\partial M_z}{\partial x} + (I_{yz}) \frac{\partial M_y}{\partial x} \right] + z \left[(I_{yz}) \frac{\partial M_z}{\partial x} + (I_z) \frac{\partial M_y}{\partial x} \right]}{(I_y)(I_z) - (I_{yz})^2}$$

- Using the relations $V_y = -\frac{dM_z}{dx}$ and $V_z = \frac{dM_y}{dx}$ (derived at the end of Section 4.4 in the textbook) yields:

$$\frac{\partial \sigma_x}{\partial x} = \frac{-y \left[(I_y) (-V_y) + (I_{yz}) (+V_z) \right] + z \left[(I_{yz}) (-V_y) + (I_z) (+V_z) \right]}{(I_y)(I_z) - (I_{yz})^2}$$

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- Recall the boxed equation from Mar 13 →

$$(q_{out}) - (q_{in}) = \int_{A'} \frac{\partial \sigma_x}{\partial x} dA$$

- Inserting our expression for $\frac{d\sigma_x}{dx}$ into this equation yields:

$$(q_{out}) - (q_{in}) = \int_{A'} \left\{ \frac{-y \left[(I_y) (-V_y) + (I_{yz}) (+V_z) \right] + z \left[(I_{yz}) (-V_y) + (I_z) (+V_z) \right]}{(I_y) (I_z) - (I_{yz})^2} \right\} dA$$

- Rearranging gives:

$$(q_{out}) - (q_{in}) = \frac{(I_y) V_y - (I_{yz}) V_z}{(I_y) (I_z) - (I_{yz})^2} \int_{A'} y dA + \frac{-(I_{yz}) V_y + (I_z) V_z}{(I_y) (I_z) - (I_{yz})^2} \int_{A'} z dA$$

- Recall that $\int_A y dA = Q_z = \bar{y}A$ and $\int_A z dA = Q_y = \bar{z}A$ (the first moments of area about the z and y axes, respectively)

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- Inserting these expressions into the above equation yields the **General Shear Flow Formula**:

$$q_{out} - q_{in} = \frac{\left(I_y V_y - I_{yz} V_z\right) \bar{y}' A' + \left(-I_{yz} V_y + I_z V_z\right) \bar{z}' A'}{I_y I_z - I_{yz}^2}$$

- We can see how the equation simplifies in certain circumstances:

- When $V_y = 0$, $q_{out} - q_{in} = \frac{(\bar{z} I_z - \bar{y} I_{yz}) V_z A'}{I_y I_z - I_{yz}^2}$
- When $V_z = 0$, $q_{out} - q_{in} = \frac{(\bar{y} I_y - \bar{z} I_{yz}) V_y A'}{I_y I_z - I_{yz}^2}$
- When $I_{yz} = 0$, $q_{out} - q_{in} = \frac{\bar{y} I_y V_y A' + \bar{z} I_z V_z A'}{I_y I_z}$
- When $V_y = 0$ and $I_{yz} = 0$, $q_{out} - q_{in} = \frac{V_z Q_y}{I_y}$
- When $V_z = 0$ and $I_{yz} = 0$, $q_{out} - q_{in} = \frac{V_y Q_z}{I_z}$

This leads to the $\tau = \frac{VQ}{Ib}$ equation we are most familiar with!